

# Lab 29 Worksheet — Windows Editions, Installation Types and Partitioning

Name: \_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_

**Exam objective:** Select the correct Windows edition and installation type for a requirement, and plan MBR or GPT partitioning to match the firmware mode (Core 2 objectives 1.1 and 1.9).

## Record as you go

| Step | What you did                                                                                                                                                                      | What you observed |
|------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| 1    | Build the edition matrix with rows for Home, Pro, Pro for Workstations and Enterprise, and columns for domain join, BitLocker, Group Policy, Remote Desktop host and maximum RAM. |                   |
| 2    | Record the decisive difference: Home cannot join a domain and has no BitLocker or Group Policy, which rules it out for almost every business deployment.                          |                   |
| 3    | Compare the installation types — clean install, in-place upgrade, network deployment and cloning — on what each preserves, what it requires and how long it takes per machine.    |                   |
| 4    | Record the valid upgrade paths: Windows 7 and 8.1 upgrade in place to Windows 10, and Windows 10 upgrades in place to Windows 11 where the hardware requirements are met.         |                   |
| 5    | Record the Windows 11 hardware requirements that block many upgrades: TPM 2.0, UEFI with Secure Boot, a 64-bit supported processor, 4 GB RAM and 64 GB storage.                   |                   |
| 6    | Record the pre-upgrade checklist: back up files and preferences, verify application and driver compatibility, verify hardware compatibility, and                                  |                   |

| Step | What you did                                                                                                                                                             | What you observed |
|------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
|      | confirm the rollback window.                                                                                                                                             |                   |
| 7    | Compare MBR and GPT on maximum disk size, partition count and firmware requirement, and record that UEFI Secure Boot requires GPT while legacy BIOS uses MBR.            |                   |
| 8    | Confirm your own machine's firmware mode and Secure Boot state, since this determines which partition scheme is valid.                                                   |                   |
| 9    | Open Disk Management and record each disk's partition style, its volumes, their file systems and their free space.                                                       |                   |
| 10   | Inspect the same information from the command line, which is what you use when Windows will not boot into the GUI.                                                       |                   |
| 11   | Distinguish primary, extended and logical partitions under MBR, and record why the four-primary limit forces an extended partition when more volumes are needed.         |                   |
| 12   | Compare a full format, which checks every sector for bad sectors, against a quick format, which only rewrites the file system table, and state when each is appropriate. |                   |

## Verification

**Success criterion:** Your edition matrix correctly identifies which editions support domain join and BitLocker, each installation-type selection is justified against its requirement, and the partition plan matches the firmware mode confirmed in msinfo32.

- I completed every step in the lab.
- My result meets the success criterion above.
- I recorded my evidence (screenshots, output, completed tables).

## Reflection

**What surprised you in this lab?**

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**Where would you apply this on the job?**

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**What do you still need to revise before the exam?**

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